The browser first makes an HTTP OPTIONS request to the target server. It includes the origin of the script making the request as the value of the Origin header, along with some headers indicating the HTTP method of the method that was requested (Access-Control-Request-Method header) and any non-standard headers that were in the original request (Access-Control-Request-Headers).

The server responds by sending back a response with headers to indicate which cross-origin requests it considers acceptable. If the original request does not match the server's response, or the server does not send any CORS headers in the response, then the browser blocks the request. If the original request is allowed, the API can also set CORS headers in the response to that request to control how much of the response is revealed to the client. An API might therefore agree to allow cross-origin requests with non-standard headers but prevent the client from reading the response.

5.1.2 CORS headers

The CORS headers that the server can send in the response are summarized in table 5.1. You can learn more about CORS headers from Mozilla's excellent article at https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/HTTP/CORS. The Access-Control-Allow-Origin and Access-Control-Allow-Credentials headers can be sent in the response to the preflight request and in the response to the actual request, whereas the other headers are sent only in response to the preflight request, as indicated in the second column where "Actual" means the header can be sent in response to the